

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 3
♥ A J T 6
♦ Q 8 3 2
♣ K J 3

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4



♠ T 5

♥ K Q 4 3

♦ J T 5 4

♣ A T 7

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 9 5 2

♦ K 9

♣ 9 8 6 2

NORTH has an opening hand, 15 points, and a 5-card ♠ suit. Unfortunately WEST beat her to the punch by opening 1♥.

But NORTH should get into the bidding anyway, by Overcalling 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 6 points. If NORTH had actually OPENED 1♠, SOUTH would be obligated to bid. But knowing that the Overcall will not be made with more than 16 points, SOUTH just passes.

West

1♥

All Pass

1♠ by North

North

1♠

East

South

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ T 3
 ♥ A Q J 6
 ♦ T 8 5
 ♣ T 8 3 2

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ T 5 2

♦ K Q 4

♣ K J 6



♠ 8 5
 ♥ K 9 4 3
 ♦ J 9 3 2
 ♣ A 9 7

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♥	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

SOUTH has an opening hand, 15 points and five ♠s. But EAST beat him to the punch, so he overcalls 1 ♠.

NORTH has 11 points, and if SOUTH had opened she would make a Limit Raise to 3 ♠.

But when replying to an Overcall, the strength needs to be a little higher. In Deal 1 it was OK to pass a 1 ♠ Overcall with 6 points, here it is correct to just raise to 2 ♠ with 11 points.

SOUTH actually has a strong Overcall so he bids 4 ♠.

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ A Q J 4
♦ Q T 4 3
♣ T 9 7

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 5 4



♠ T 8
♥ K 9 6 3
♦ J 8 5 2
♣ A Q 3

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ T 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K 8 6 2

West

1 ♥

All Pass

3 ♠ by North

North

1 ♠

East

Pass

South

3 ♠

This time NORTH has just 10 points, nowhere near an opening hand. Still, when WEST opens 1 ♥ NORTH should Overcall 1 ♠. This shows a good ♠ suit and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 13 points. If NORTH had actually OPENED 1 ♠, SOUTH would insist on game. But NORTH didn't Open, she just Overcalled. So SOUTH must be more cautious. He jumps to 3 ♠ and NORTH shows her minimum type hand by passing.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 7
 ♥ K 9 8 2
 ♦ J 6 5 2
 ♣ J 4

♠ K 9 8 6

♥ 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K Q 7 5



♠ 4 2

♥ A Q J 6 3

♦ T 9 4

♣ T 9 3

♠ A T 5 3

♥ T 7 5

♦ Q 8

♣ A 8 6 2

NORTH has 15 points, a singleton in the opponent's suit and 4-card support for any suit partner might name. In other words, a perfect Takeout Double.

SOUTH needs to make a medium-strong bid to apprise NORTH of her 10 points. She jumps to 2♠.

NORTH's hand is now worth 17 points because of the singleton. Since he is quite happy with ♠s he bids 4♠.

West

1♥

Pass

All Pass

4♠ by South

North

Dbl

4♠

East

Pass

South

2♠

Board 5

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J T 8

♥ K T 8

♦ T 7 5

♣ Q T 5

♠ 7 6 4 2

♥ 7 6 3

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 9 8



♠ A K 9

♥ Q 9 5

♦ A 9 3 2

♣ A 6 3

♠ 5 3

♥ A J 4 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K 7 4 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♣

1♠

Dbl

All Pass

2♣ by North

SOUTH has 14 points, a doubleton in the opponent's ♠ suit and at least three cards in each of the other suits. This is a normal Takeout Double.

NORTH has a really awful hand. He has just one point and his only 4-card suit is the one the opponents have already bid. He wants nothing more than to pass.

But he cannot pass. Partner's Double said "Bid your best suit.", so he bids 2♣.

Mercifully SOUTH also passes.